



▲ ITC NARMADA AHMEDABAD

ITC will expand the Mementos brand (currently in Udaipur and Jaipur) to Siliguri and open a new hotel in Patna, the city's first five-star



WHEN THE FAIRMONT Udaipur Palace opened its doors this April, it did not slip quietly into Rajasthan's backdrop of *havelis*, becoming another palace hotel. The sprawling 327-room

Rajput-style structure built into the Aravallis and spread across ballrooms, gardens and terraces, launched with a spectacle: a 700-guest wedding. The hotel was sold out on Day 1.

Over the next few weeks, it hosted 19 more weddings through the summer months (considered off season),

each generating ₹5-6 crore. Starting October and all the way to March, when the high season begins, the property is booked for seven-eight weddings a month, with bills exceeding ₹10-11 crore per wedding. In India, the peak wedding season is between November and February, when business is brisk.

"What Udaipur lacked was scale," says Somesh Agarwal, Chairman and Managing Director of ROCKWOOD Hotels & Keystone Hotels that owns the property. "Most luxury hotels here are in the 80- to 130-room range. We brought in scale, which is